SPOTLIGHT: EDUCATION IN THE HIMALAYAN FOOTHILLS



RAJU BASNET
Minister of Education, Sikkim

"We used to send children from humble backgrounds to affluent schools outside Sikkim, but their integration was difficult. That's why our CM started our own residential model school—fully free"

SONY VIRDI, *Founder, Zion Education Trust, and Chairman, CII, Sikkim State Council*

"Let's think about the year 2045.... If our children are not technologically driven, they will be left behind. Government jobs may not exist by then—they must be market-ready"

PROF. ASHIS SHARMA
Vice-Chancellor, Khangchendzonga State University, Gangtok

"[Under] the Chief Minister Internship Scheme, graduates are given hands-on experience.... Colleges and universities are also following the scheme"

GREEN GOVERNANCE: SIKKIM'S GLOBAL STANDARD IN ORGANIC FARMING AND SUSTAINABLE FORESTRY

PRADEEP KUMAR
Forest Secretary, Sikkim

"Sikkim is an example for the entire country—not only how to go organic, but how to stay organic...it has also managed to increase its forest cover"





BUDHA HANG SUBBA, *Progressive kiwi cultivator*

"Kiwi is the king of fruits—full of vitamins and potassium.... The challenge is marketing. That is the gap we need to fill"

DR S. ANBALAGAN
CEO, Sikkim Organic Farming Development Agency

"We've shifted from production-side policies to marketing...linking producers to buyers and ensuring fair price discovery"





SWAPAN MEHRA
Founder & CEO, IORA Ecological Solutions

"Sikkim can earn over Rs 150–200 cr. annually through carbon and biodiversity credit markets just for maintaining its ecosystems"